

“Capitalise On ‘CHINA PLUS TWO,’ Where Products With Higher Value Addition **BECOME THE FOCUS**”

One of EPIC Foundation’s goals is “Transforming India into an electronics hardware product nation.” Aren’t we already well along that path, with the numerous policies that the government has introduced?

I have seen many Indian brands vanish despite favourable government policies for manufacturing. Now, that’s a very terrible situation to be in! At a time when the government has come up with great policies for manufacturing products in India, the question that remains is, how many Indian companies are benefiting from it? A few Indian companies, like Dixon and VVDN, manufacture for others, but a lack of Indian products globally is evident. This is not a good situation for a large country like India; we must have our own product ecosystem.

So, how is EPIC Foundation working to build India’s product ecosystem, and who funds these activities?

EPIC advocates for building a product industry alongside semiconductor and component manufacturing as part of the India Semiconductor Mission Advisory Board. Manufacturing alone won’t suffice without solid product demand. Companies like Dixon are considering designing and manufacturing their products, but more must follow to compete globally. Our goal at EPIC is to collaborate with governments, fostering a comprehensive product ecosystem around universities, design houses, and startups. Over the next decade, this decentralised approach across the country can create a thriving design and product ecosystem, competing with China. By nurturing hundreds of brands, we can seize the opportunity created by the trust deficit with China, attracting



EPIC Foundation aims to transform India into an electronics hardware product nation by collaborating with governments, universities, design houses, and startups. In a conversation with EFY’s Yashasvini Razdan, the Foundation’s Chairman and Former HCL Co-founder Ajai Chowdhry advocates for SME-friendly incentive schemes and stresses on developing a VC ecosystem for hardware